



Qualification Programme Examination Panelist's Report

Module 5 – Information Management (December 2022 Session)

(The main purpose of the following report is to summarise candidates' common weaknesses and make recommendations to help future candidates improve their performance in the examination.)

(I) Section A – Multiple Choice Questions

General Comments

This paper consisted of 20 multiple choice (MC) questions. Candidates had to complete all the questions. The coverage of the questions was widely distributed among the topics of the syllabus as follows:

- (a) Analyse the role of e-Commerce;
- (b) Analyse the risks and security issues of information management;
- (c) Categorise the nature and account for the value of information systems;
- (d) Describe and apply corporate information systems;
- (e) Analyse systems development processes; and
- (f) Use information technology applications.

The performance in the MC questions was fair, as these are usually short and straightforward questions.

Specific Comments

Candidates showed weaknesses in the following areas:

- (a) Categorising the nature of, and accounting for, the value of information systems – areas of competitive advantage and functions of information;
- (b) Analysing the role of e-Commerce – general duties of a business process improvement team; and
- (c) Using information technology applications – differences between Internet service providers and backbone providers.

(II) Section B – Written Questions

General Comments

Similar to the previous cohorts, most candidates performed well in some of the general and fundamental topics, especially in the syllabus area of “Applying information systems in a corporate setting” and the “Nature and value of information systems”. However, many candidates demonstrated a weak performance in some specific IT topics, such as



robotic process automation, risk and security and infrastructure supporting corporate information systems.

Specific Comments

Question 1(a) – 4 Marks

This question required candidates to contrast the difference between a direct cutover implementation strategy and a side-by-side implementation strategy.

Performance was good. A few candidates confused a side-by-side implementation strategy with a phased implementation strategy.

Question 1(b) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to justify why a side-by-side implementation strategy is the least risky approach in system conversion.

Performance was good.

Question 1(c)(i) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to state any two duties of accounting during the testing stage of a system conversion.

Performance was good.

Question 1(c)(ii) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to state any two duties of accounting during the operation and maintenance stage of a system conversion.

Performance was good.

Question 1(d) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to demonstrate any two ways that an organisation can support a system change through revising management policies.

Performance was less than satisfactory. Many candidates did not further elaborate how to implement the suggested policies.

Question 2(a)(i) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to define biometric authentication.

Performance was good. However, some candidates failed to use other words to



explain the term “authentication”.

Question 2(a)(ii) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to demonstrate any three biometric factors of using a fingerprint authentication system.

Performance was moderate. Some candidates could not mention the correct factor(s) nor provide a correct demonstration with a specific biometric factor.

Question 2(b)(i) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to demonstrate how hackers could conduct a man-in-the-middle (MITM) attack through a wireless router or a wireless access point.

Performance was not satisfactory. Many candidates could not mention how the hackers could conduct a man-in-the-middle (MITM) attack through a wireless router or a wireless access point. Most of them could only mention the impact or consequence of the affected people/organisation.

Question 2(b)(ii) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to demonstrate how hackers could conduct a MITM attack through a web browser.

Performance was not satisfactory. Many candidates could not mention how the hackers could conduct a MITM attack through a web browser. Most of them could only mention about the impact or consequence of the affected people/organisation.

Question 2(c)(i) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to define virtual private network (VPN).

Performance was less than satisfactory. Many candidates mentioned that it is a type of internal network connection only. A few candidates mentioned that a VPN is used for browsing some restricted webpages, which is not the correct purpose of using a VPN.

Question 2(c)(ii) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to explain why a VPN could be used to prevent the MITM attack as stated in Question 2(b)(i).

Performance was not satisfactory. As many candidates were not able to mention how the hackers could conduct a MITM attack through a web browser, they could not further explain why a VPN could be used to prevent the MITM attack.



Question 3(a) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to categorise some given types of information into strategic level, tactical level or operational level.

Performance was good.

Question 3(b) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to describe the basic function of various types of information systems – a transaction processing system, a management information system, an expert system and an executive information system.

Performance was more than satisfactory. However, some candidates were not familiar with an expert system and an executive information system.

Question 3(c) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to state and describe any three types of ethical or legal issues that an organisation may face when using information systems.

Performance was not satisfactory. Many candidates repeatedly mentioned data privacy or some of the principles of the Personal Data (Privacy) Ordinance. However, data privacy is one of the possible issues in this question.

Question 4(a)(i) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to list any two types of information needs of a human resources department.

Performance was good.

Question 4(a)(ii) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to list any two types of information needs of a marketing department.

Performance was good.

Question 4(b)(i) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to contrast any three differences between a server and a client under the client-server model.

Performance was not satisfactory. Many candidates were not familiar with the client-server model in computing/ networking. Some of them misunderstood the term “client” in this model as a human user.



Question 4(b)(ii) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to justify the importance of using a network switch in a client-server network.

Performance was not satisfactory. Most of the candidates were not familiar with a network switch and its major function. However, it is quite commonly used in our daily life.

Question 5(a) – 4 Marks

This question required candidates to determine any two risks that may occur if an e-commerce business has weak identity authentication among its customers and suppliers.

Performance was good.

Question 5(b) – 5 Marks

This question required candidates to contrast the differences between e-commerce and e-business.

Performance was fair. However, many candidates could not mention that e-commerce is a part of the e-business. Some candidates focused on describing some e-commerce related features only.

Question 5(c)(i) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to define robotic process automation (RPA).

Performance was satisfactory. However, some candidates were not familiar with this technology.

Question 5(c)(ii) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to list any two examples of using RPA in accounting.

Performance was less than satisfactory. Many candidates mentioned some general functions of accounting software/systems, like generating financial reports or recording journal entries without further description.

(III) Conclusion and Recommendation

The overall performance of the candidates in this examination was satisfactory. Candidates performed better in the syllabus area of “Analyse systems development process”.

However, candidates performed poorly in relation to the syllabus areas of “Risks and



security of information management” and “Infrastructure supporting corporate information systems” as well as not being able to understand the requirements of the verb “demonstrate”.

Candidates should spend more time and effort to get familiar with the topics in these areas, study the HKICPA Taxonomy, understand the requirements of different verbs and check and identify any changes of the syllabus or learning outcomes when they are preparing for the examination. Candidates are also reminded to read the questions carefully and address what is being asked.